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CHINA

F 3954

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FROM Parliamentary Question (Mr Teeling).

No.

Dated 9 Mar 49

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F : China

Control of Formosa.

Mr Teeling asked what steps were being taken to ensure that control of Formosa did not pass to any Government other than that of China recognised by Britain and U.S.A.

Mr McNeil replied that steps contemplated by Mr Teeling could only be taken on the basis of consultation among the Powers concerned.

Last Paper

F3546

References

(Minutes)

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EW 26/10/49

Next Paper

FA385

Far Eastern

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Parliamentary Question

* 69. Mr. Teeling,—To ask the Secretary of State for Foreign Affairs, what steps are being taken to see that no other Government than the Chinese Government recognised by Great Britain and the United States takes control of Formosa until a Peace Treaty with Japan has been signed. *

U.

Brighton

ANSWERED 14 MAR 1949

REPLY ATTACHED.

9 MAR 1949

The position regarding Formosa is briefly as follows. The island was internationally recognised as being under Japanese sovereignty before the war. At Cairo on the 1st December, 1943 President Roosevelt, Generalissimo Chiang Kai-shek and Mr. Churchill declared "that all the territories that Japan has stolen from the Chinese such as Manchuria, Formosa, and the Pescadores shall be restored to the Republic of China". The Heads of the Governments of the United States, United Kingdom and China reaffirmed that "the terms of the Cairo Declaration shall be carried out" in the Potsdam Declaration issued on the 26th July, 1945. The Potsdam Proclamation was subsequently adhered to by the Soviet Union. When Japan surrendered she accepted the Potsdam Proclamation and surrendered, in fact, to the four Potsdam Powers. It was as a result of agreement among these Powers that General MacArthur was appointed to be Supreme Commander for the Allied Powers "for the purpose of enforcing the surrender of Japan", and it was on the basis of a directive agreed upon by the same four Powers that Japanese forces in Formosa were eventually instructed to surrender to Chiang Kai-shek. A Chinese Military Administration was thereupon set up in Formosa and subsequently superseded by a Chinese Civil Administration which is still in existence. Thus the Chinese, in view of the Cairo Declaration, appear to have been permitted to assume the administration of Formosa (which is legally still under Japanese sovereignty) without there being any very precise international agreement on the subject. We are aware that the Americans are at present showing great interest in the future of Formosa and that some American circles think it desirable that Formosa should be withheld from the Chinese Communists. But American intentions are not yet clarified and we clearly do not wish to be drawn into any speculation on possible future developments.

Mr. Teeling's present question presumably arises out of the supplementary to the question on Formosa he asked on March 2nd. Both questions were possibly prompted by the China Association, whom we know to be concerned about the future of Formosa, and on whose behalf Mr. Teeling has asked questions in the past.

The present question is an embarrassing one for the following reasons:

(a) /

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(a) although Formosa is not yet technically Chinese it could be argued that any steps such as Mr. Teeling suggests would amount to taking sides in the civil war. But we should not wish to say this since it is conceivable that the Americans may eventually wish to take some move to keep the Communists out of Formosa;

(b) in our view Formosa remains in theory at the disposal of the four Powers to whom Japan surrendered (China, the U.K., U.S.S.R. and the U.S.). But here again we are not particularly anxious to emphasise the position of the Soviet Union in this matter;

(c) there may be a stage when we shall recognise <u>two</u> Chinese Governments <u>de facto</u>; and in any case, should we ever recognise the Chinese Communist Government as the <u>de jure</u> Government of China our obligation under the Cairo Declaration would pass to the successor Government.

Draft reply submitted.

F. S. Tomlinson
7th March, 1949.

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I tried to indicate to Mr. Teeling at dinner the other night that he was treading on dangerous ground over Formosa (it was the day he asked his previous question). But I do not appear to have succeeded.

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CHINA

Formosa (Control)

6. **Mr. William Teeling** asked the Secretary of State for Foreign Affairs what steps are being taken to see that no other Government than the Chinese Government recognised by Great Britain and the United States takes control of Formosa until a Peace Treaty with Japan has been signed.

Mr. McNeil: As far as His Majesty's Government in the United Kingdom are concerned, the answer is "None." Any steps such as the hon. Member contemplates could only be taken on the back of consultation among the Powers concerned.

Mr. Teeling: In view of the fact that the United States has already stated that Formosa would be in its line of defence, surely some steps must be taken soon, since China is at the present time lent Formosa and we do not know what the new Chinese Government is going to be; it might be Communist.

Mr. McNeil: It is fairly difficult to describe the status of Formosa. "Lent" would be one word, but not necessarily an accurate one. I must repeat that no action can be unilateral; it would be a matter for the Powers concerned.

14 MAR 1949

Deferred to 14.3.49.

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6 DEFERRED FROM 9th

* ~~69.~~ Mr. Teeling,—To ask the Secretary of State for Foreign Affairs, what steps are being taken to see that no other Government than the Chinese Government recognised by Great Britain and the United States takes control of Formosa until a Peace Treaty with Japan has been signed. *

9 MAR 1949

Draft Reply to P.Q.
No. +69. Mr. Teeling
9th March, 1949.

As far as His Majesty's Government in the United Kingdom are concerned the answer is, none, Sir. Any steps such as the honourable Member contemplates could only be taken on the basis of consultation among the Powers concerned.

Notes for Supplementaries

If Mr. Teeling should ask who are the Powers concerned, the answer might be:

"The Powers most obviously concerned are the signatories to the Cairo Declaration."

Mr. Teeling may ask whether H.M.G. have been in consultation with any other Powers about the future of Formosa. Although we have had some inconclusive discussions on the subject with the Americans at the official level, and we should expect to hear more of their intentions when they have crystalised, it would be desirable to avoid a specific reply to any such question. The answer might be:

"We are in constant consultation with all friendly Powers on matters of common interest."